

by two percent. And that trend is unlikely to go up considering the surge in robotics that is due. We are not talking about mere robots routinely doing the same job over and over again – that has been happening for quite a while. If you check out the warehouses of companies like Flipkart, DTDC, Delhivery and other big names in logistics, you're likely to find a box-like machine with cameras installed on it, taking and placing packages in designated positions with hardly any human supervision required.

That's a Butler, developed by Gurgaon-based Greyorange. Yes, it

comes to manufacturing products, there's not much option that the companies are left with.

And then there are other cutting-edge technologies that are converging with AI and bringing newer challenges to the employment scenario. While self-driving cars have been declared unfeasible for Indian roads, the same logistics scenario described earlier is being scaled to a entire industrial complex with dedicated roads for automated carts and carriers. Drones with AI capabilities can monitor crops for infestation, pests and create a scenario where fewer farm hands are

it based on what it requires from us to do its job. And just like its been said time and again, newer jobs will be available. Jobs like:

- Man-machine coordinator: With fewer lower level employees, management level jobs will be transformed into coordination jobs between machines and human employees. This role would require the ability to combine the strengths of machines (analysis, diligence, speed etc) with that of humans (empathy, judgement, etc).
- Data analysis: Yes, that does sound like something that computers have been doing for ages. We're talking about the use case where something goes wrong and the logic on which the AI works itself makes a mistake, which might just need some human insight.
- AI-Assisted Healthcare Technician: One of the many specialised roles in India today that could use AI help is that of a doctor. And with AI-assisted healthcare, someone with basic medical knowhow can provide healthcare in inaccessible places, with a doctor remotely available if needed
- And more.

Bengaluru-based software giant Infosys has changed the way it trains its employees. Bringing in newer AI skills as part of the training for existing employees, the company hopes to be at the forefront of AI development without risking the jobs of its employees. For a large part, the Government needs to do something similar, as well as push Industrial reforms that promote industries that generate jobs. Along with that, the entire education system needs to focus on developing newer skills rather than producing run-of-the-mill software engineers. All of these do seem like quite ambitious tasks, but when more than 200 million people in the country are at the risk of losing their jobs, it is time for extreme measures. 



AI powered drones could automate agriculture to a large extent

is doing something pretty basic in terms of reading a package number off a box using image recognition and matching it against one in a database, then judging the size of the box and using its arms to carry it accordingly. But remember, all we had in the name of robots a few years before were simple welders and robot arms. Fast forward to today, Honda's factory in Vithalapur has the shop floor completely automated, with robots manufacturing components 24x7 with an efficiency greater than humans. It employs 14 people, whereas it would have employed 72 people without robots. And thanks to the cutthroat competition when it

needed. Stretching the capabilities of AI, virtually no job is safe. But that is not the end of the story.

New avenues

What we've been talking about so far is largely termed as Industry 4.0. In this, the role of a human is still present – but certainly not intact. So far, we've been in the driving position in most jobs, including the kind that we've undertaken in India. The new wave of jobs are bound to be created with rising automation require a more comprehensive expertise of the entire process being undertaken. Rather than telling a software what is to be done, we'll be communicating with